

Golden Image - BuildAdmin Automation

Runbook for **Set-GoldenImageProfile.ps1** (v14.0) | Windows 11 Pro 24H2/25H2 | Windows Endpoint Toolkit

This script automates the proven manual image-prep process. You set up the reference account (TemplateUser) by hand, then - signed in as a separate clean admin (BuildAdmin) with TemplateUser signed out - you run this once. It disables BitLocker and auto sign-in, takes ownership of the Default profile, copies the entire TemplateUser profile into Default (including NTUSER.DAT), resets the owner to SYSTEM, and verifies the result. Wallpaper and the logon policies are set by you in Group Policy on TemplateUser, not by the script.

IMPORTANT: Run this from the BuildAdmin account, NOT from TemplateUser, and with TemplateUser fully signed out. Test only with a brand-new user - never TemplateUser or BuildAdmin.

Account roles

- **TemplateUser** - first local admin (OOBE). You configure this to look how every imaged profile should look.
- **BuildAdmin** - second local admin, left unconfigured. Only used to run the script.
- **TestUser** - brand-new account used only to verify the result after imaging.

Manual steps - A. OOBE, create a LOCAL account

Power on the blank laptop and proceed through OOBE to the first screens. At OOBE, open a command prompt (Shift+F10 or CMD) and run:

```
oobe\bypassnro
```

The machine reboots into OOBE. Continue, and at the network step choose "**I don't have internet**", then "**Continue with limited setup**". Create the first local admin: **TemplateUser**. Do not let Windows Updates apply.

TIP: If "I don't have internet" does not appear, physically disconnect from the internet (unplug Ethernet / turn off Wi-Fi) to force the option.

Manual steps - B. Configure TemplateUser

Log in as TemplateUser and set up the look every imaged profile should have:

- Install and configure all applications.
- Desktop icons and shortcuts; taskbar pins; any per-user appearance (colors, etc.).

Then set the local Group Policy items in **gpedit.msc** (machine-level; they survive imaging):

- **Wallpaper** - User Config > Administrative Templates > Desktop > Desktop > Desktop Wallpaper > Enabled; set the image path (a path present on imaged machines) and style.
- **Disclaimer title & text** - Computer Config > Windows Settings > Security Settings > Local Policies > Security Options > "Message title / Message text for users attempting to log on".
- **Require Ctrl+Alt+Del** - same node > "Do not require CTRL+ALT+DEL" > Disabled.
- **Hide last signed-in user** - same node > "Don't display last signed-in" > Enabled.
- Any other local Group Policy you want baked into the image.

TIP: Lock screen image and profile picture are intentionally NOT part of this process - they were unreliable and are not used.

Manual steps - C. Create build account and hand off

- Create a SECOND local admin (**BuildAdmin**). Do not configure it.
- Put **Set-GoldenImageProfile.ps1** in **C:\Scripts**.
- **Sign out** of TemplateUser completely (Start > user icon > Sign out - not lock).
- Log in as **BuildAdmin** and run the script (below).

TIP: If your first admin is not named exactly TemplateUser, change the \$RefUser line near the top of the script to match.

Running the script

From **BuildAdmin**, open **PowerShell as Administrator** and run:

```
Set-ExecutionPolicy Bypass -Scope Process
cd C:\Scripts
.\Set-GoldenImageProfile.ps1
```

TIP: Watch for the COMPLETE banner and read the verification lines above it. The script can never hang - every external command is timeout-protected, and it always ends with COMPLETE or ENDED EARLY.

What the script does, in order

Step	What happens
1. Pre-flight	Confirms it is NOT running as TemplateUser, that TemplateUser exists and is signed out, and that Default exists.
2. BitLocker	Turns BitLocker off on C: (decrypts). Required to deploy; decryption finishes in the background.

3. Auto sign-in	Disables AutoAdminLogon, the automatic restart sign-on policy, and Fast Startup for a clean logon screen.
4. Ownership	Takes ownership of C:\Users\Default for Administrators, grants Full Control, replaces child entries, enables inheritance.
5. Copy	Copies the ENTIRE TemplateUser profile into Default, including NTUSER.DAT, replacing what it can and skipping anything locked.
6. Reset owner	Resets the Default profile owner back to SYSTEM so Windows clones it cleanly.
7. Verify	Confirms NTUSER.DAT landed, shortcuts copied, file counts, SYSTEM owns Default, auto sign-in and Fast Startup off, BitLocker status.

After it completes

- Let BitLocker finish decrypting: **manage-bde -status C:** (wait for Fully Decrypted).
- **Reboot.**
- Optional: create a brand-new local user and log in to spot-check the look.
- Capture the image with your deployment tool (MDT, SCCM, ManageEngine, etc.) and deploy it. New users who sign in on a deployed device inherit the configured Default profile.

If something is not right

Symptom	Fix
"running as TemplateUser" abort	Sign out of TemplateUser, log in as BuildAdmin, re-run.
"Reference profile not found"	First admin is not named TemplateUser - set \$RefUser at the top of the script.
WARN: TemplateUser still has a session	It was locked, not signed out. Fully sign it out and re-run.
Many files skipped in copy	TemplateUser session still active (files locked). Sign it out and re-run.
Login still shows last user after imaging	The hide-user local GP was not set on TemplateUser - set it in gpedit before imaging.